

It doesn't have to be this way

The few times we think about our energy usage the reason is usually **shocking**. When your summer bill is more than you thought, your winter bill is more than you thought, your power goes out, or even when your kids leave on every light in the house.

We all know we should be doing more, yet we don't, or at least we only do something for a short time. As soon as your bill returns to normal, we will revert to the old ways.

It doesn't have to be this way.

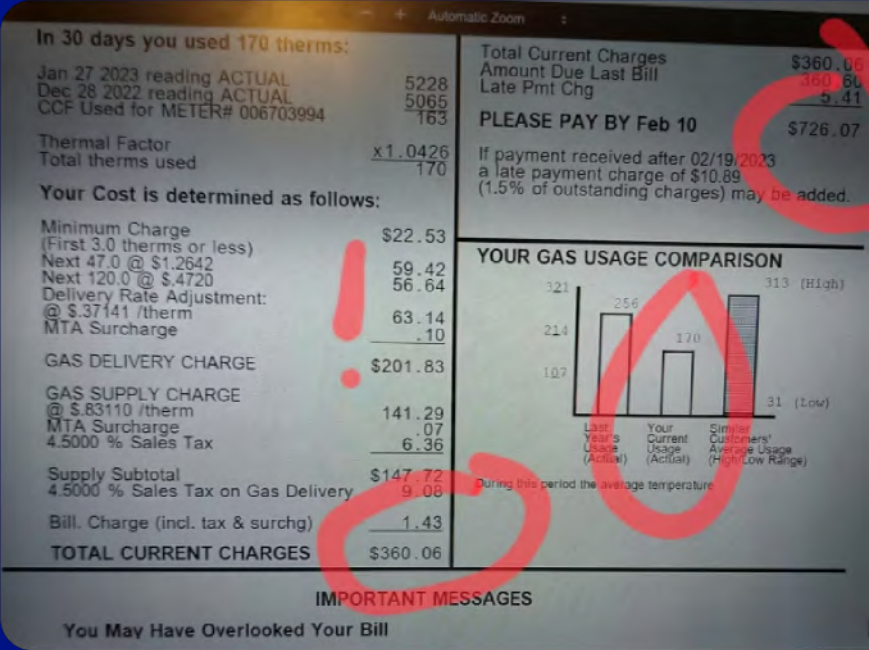
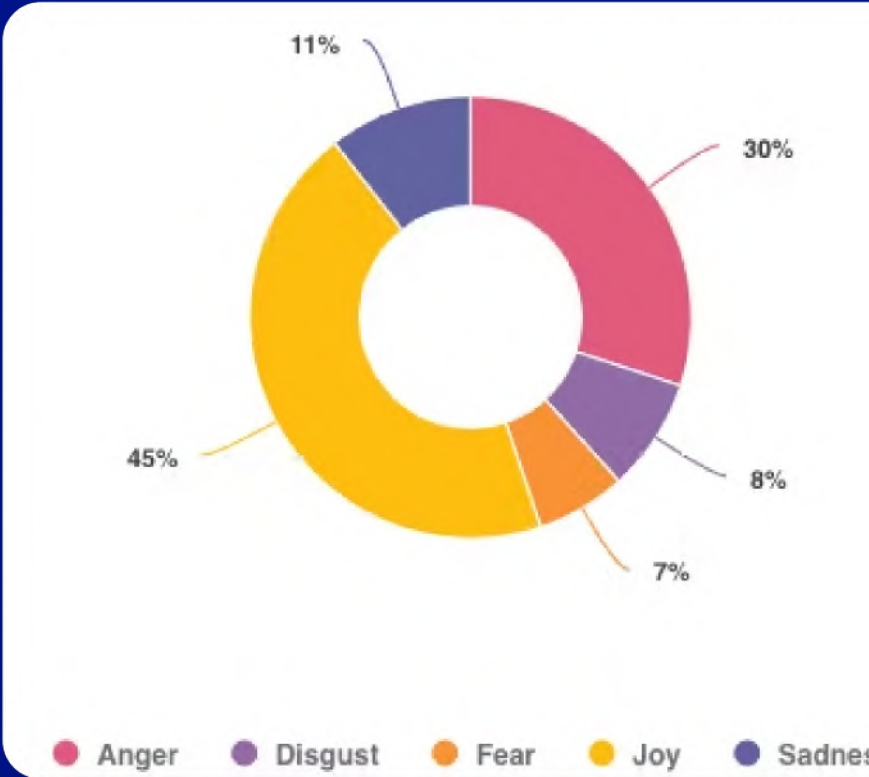
Matt Grabowski, PA-C @mattgrobo · Jan 26
Replying to @KatrinaKNews and @nationalgridus
It's awful that they coincidentally raised rates just when it was getting colder out. What a greedy company.

John Lynch @JohnLynchBooks · Sep 24, 2022
Going to be a 47 percent increase in electricity bills in RI starting October. Of course they cited the economy and Ukraine, which is bullshit. Sure that's the cause, but it's the cause because they know they can use it as the excuse

Matt Serafini @MattFini
Replying to @JohnLynchBooks
64% here through National Grid. Absolutely insane. People are going to lose their minds when it takes them by surprise.

Sane Energy Project @SaneEnergy
Seabrook calls National Grid "the provider of life-saving energy for our four million customers." That's an amazing way of talking about the fossil fuels that are poisoning our air, creating continuous disasters, and foreclosing our future!

Katrina Kincade @KatrinaKNews
My gas + electric really went from paying \$400 last winter to \$900. There's only two of us living in my apartment. This is inhumane @nationalgridus.



Five Hypotheses

1.

People are angry when their bills are higher and they blame you.

2.

Customers don't care about your goals and helping you reach them if there is no immediate benefit to them.

3.

People don't want to think about their energy. They just want to be comfortable and safe with no surprises.

4.

Information needs to be put in the context of the customers situation of use and how it might affect them.

5.

Before we can change behavior, we have to earn the customer's trust every day by doing little things to make them feel in control.

You in charge of yours.

Customers feel trapped, manipulated, confused, and, yes, powerless. We must help customers feel they have the choice and control to make meaningful changes.

You in charge of yours signals that we want them to feel part of the solution, that they can be the ones who can decide to turn up the heat if grandma is over, but it is up to us to make sure they know the cause and effect so it is their informed decision so there are no surprises.

It starts with reducing the complexity, providing context, and earning their trust daily.

Winning today is no surprise making winning tomorrow a nice surprise.



Guiding Principles

Are these right for you? Maybe not, but we can work with you to create the right ones. But to engage, inform, and activate customers, we'll need to employ key principles to stay on our trajectory and build momentum to hit our goals.

► Be Helpful

We need to make it about them. So much of what you have today is accurate but not helpful or engaging.

► Be Visual

Long pages of text go unread until they are engaged. How can we tell the story in a more visually compelling way?

► Be Specific

Lets try to remove ambiguity whenever we can by providing clear and specific guidance by shaping the path we need them to follow.

► Be Supportive

Once customers have built a baseline understanding we need to make sure they have the tools and the motivation to continue.

► Be Simple

Customers don't want to be energy experts, so let's not complicate things. Make it obvious. Make it simple.

How do you think your customers are feeling?

How do we reframe how we think about them to change the future?



The Resistant



The Apathetic



The Engaged



The Motivated



The Activated



The Resistant

What they think now:

My gas & electric really went from paying \$400 last winter to \$900. There's only two of us living in my apartment. This is inhumane. What a greedy company.

What we want them to think

I thought National Grid was greedy, but it turns out that if I reach out to them, they are more than willing to help me use my energy wisely to benefit my neighbors and me.

Themes that will move them

- Simple, convenient choices
- National Grid is here to help
- Customer Service over-achieves
- Get in touch and we will help
- There is a better way

We need to dial down the intensity. Choices need to be simple and clear, and we need to break the status quo and help them climb out of the trust deficit.

What percentage of your audience falls into this group?

What would you like it to be?